

STIRRED UP
PFI activists face police action during a protest in Thiruvananthapuram, Jun. 6

THE ANATOMY OF AN EXTREMIST OUTFIT

ORIGINS: The PFI was set up in 2006

MEMBERS: 400,000 across 23 states (claimed)

CONSTITUTION: Drafted in 2010, it sets out an 18-point agenda including promoting national integration and social harmony, upholding the country's democratic and secular order, working for peace, advancing the cause of minorities, protecting civil and political rights and speaking out against human rights violations

THE ORGANISATION: The local unit has 20 members; 3-10 units form an area, 3-10 areas form a division, 3-10 divisions form a district, and more than two districts form a zone. Each state has a general assembly and executive council. State representatives convene to form the national general assembly and executive council

UNIFORM: PFI members wear a blue uniform at meetings and events, with stars and emblems on the shoulders

PFI'S ASSOCIATES

BANNED: Rehab India Foundation, Campus Front of India, All India Imams Council, National Confederation of Human Rights Organizations, National Women's Front, Junior Front, Empower India Foundation and Rehab Foundation, Kerala

NOT BANNED: Social Democratic Party of India (SDPI)

THE FACES OF PFI



OVUNGAL ABDUL SALAM, 49
Chairman (arrested)

Earlier employed with the Kerala State Electricity Board as a senior assistant, he was sacked by the government for travelling to Gulf countries (six times) without taking permission. A former SIMI member, he belongs to Pattarkulam near Manjeri in Malappuram district



E.M. ABDUL RAHIMAN, 58
Vice-chairman (arrested)

A science graduate who also holds a master's degree in political science, he's a former librarian and a fiery orator and writer



PARAPPURATH KOYA, 72
Ideologue (arrested)

Also known as Kaleem, he is known for his oratory, radical views and is well networked with global Islamic organisations. A former English professor, he also holds a law degree. Was a member of SIMI



E. ABUBACKER, 72, *Member, National Executive Council (arrested)*

A founding member, Abubacker is a former high school Arabic teacher. He also headed the political wing, SDPI. The Kerala president of SIMI in 1982, he is also a founder member of the All-India Muslim Personal Law Board. He founded Rehab India Foundation, an NGO run by the PFI. Well-known for his organising skills, Islamic network and radical views



NASARUDHEEN ELAMARAM, 54
National Secretary (arrested)

A matriculate, Elamaram reportedly has great organising skills. Known for his radical stand and provocative speeches